



Continuous scrolling with Google

Google's app will now automatically load the next page instead of the usual "tap for the next page". <https://digit.in/nov21-19>



Visible customer data hacked

Visible had its customer data hacked and hackers are making unauthorised purchases from it. <https://digit.in/nov21-20>

Esoteric Ways of Using Microsoft Excel and Google Sheets

Useful functions in Excel and Sheets

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icrosoft Excel continues to be the de facto program for all kinds of spreadsheet work, simple and

complex. Of late, online alternatives such as Google Sheets and Microsoft's own Excel web app have made real-time collaboration a walk in the park. In this walkthrough, we will look at some very useful but not often used or widely known functions in Microsoft Excel and/or Google Sheets and see how they can simplify our work. This article assumes that the reader has a basic understanding of how spreadsheets work. Let's get started.

CREATE A DEPENDENT DROPDOWN LIST IN GOOGLE SHEETS

Dropdown lists can be very useful in allowing users to triage data without having to resort to create filters each time or fiddle with macros and code. A dependent dropdown list is one that offers options relevant to what was selected in a previous dropdown in the same sheet. This allows for more granular filtering of data.

1. Open the spreadsheet in Google Sheets and select the data for which you want to create the first dropdown list. Ideally, it's good to use the first row for the headers. In our example, we want to create two dropdowns that include First Name and Country. In this case, this would be the B and C columns.
2. Now, select the B column that has

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I
1		Country	First Name	Last Name	Gender	Age	Date	Id	
2	1	United States	Dulce	Abriil	Female	32	15/10/2017	1562	
3	2	Great Britain	Mara	Hashimoto	Female	25	16/08/2016	1582	
4	3	France	Philip	Gent	Male	36	21/05/2015	2587	
5	4	United States	Kathleen	Hanner	Female	25	15/10/2017	3549	
6	5	United States	Nereida	Magwood	Female	58	16/08/2016	2468	
7	6	United States	Gaston	Brumm	Male	24	21/05/2015	2554	
8	7	Great Britain	Etta	Hurn	Female	56	15/10/2017	3598	
9	8	United States	Earlean	Melgar	Female	27	16/08/2016	2456	
10	9	United States	Vincenza	Welland	Female	40	21/05/2015	6548	

Select the columns for which a dropdown list is needed

the First Names without the heading row. So, this would mean cells from B2 to B10.

3. Navigate to the Data menu and click on Named ranges.
4. This opens a side pane on the right. Change the name to exactly match that of the header, which in this case is "First Name". Click on Done.

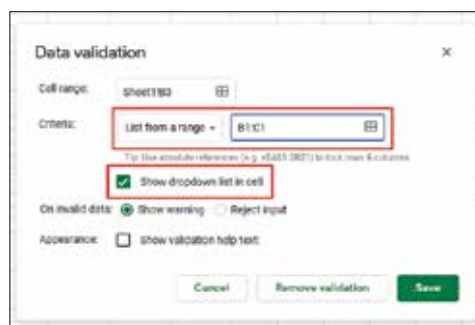
Do note that Sheets will not accept names with spaces in the Named ranges pane. So, if you have two words in the heading, use an underscore or shorten it to a single word.

5. Once you've pressed Done, Sheets will create the range and give you the option to add another range.
6. Click on Add a range in the Named ranges pane and repeat the process above, this time for the second dropdown, i.e., Country. Once again, be careful with the naming.
7. Now that we have created two named ranges, we can insert them in the sheet as needed.
8. Select any cell, then go to the Data menu and click on Data Validation.
9. In the dialogue box that opens, in the Criteria section, select List from a range, and enter the header cells. Also, make sure that the Show dropdown list in cell option is

checked. Now, click on Save to create a dropdown.

Ensure that the data columns for which you want to create dependent dropdowns are next to other.

10. The dropdown will now contain a list of the column names we have selected in the Data validation tool.
11. Before we move on to create another dropdown list, we must first make the first list dynamic. For this we use the INDIRECT function in Sheets to reference and list all the entries pertaining to the Country dropdown, making the dropdowns dynamic.
12. Repeat the above steps to create the second dropdown for First Name. But now, select the output from the INDIRECT function we had got in the previous step and click on Save to create the second dropdown.



Select the cells for Data validation